likely to get accentuated with IoT and widespread digitalization. This is resulting in declining labour participation rate.

Second, the workplace has been transformed significantly.

Workplaces, specifically factories, which employ the most workers in organized establishments, have changed a great deal over the past two centuries with increasing automation. With steam technology being replaced by electricity, there is literally no soot, excessive humidity and heat in most factories. With improvement in mechanical and electrical engineering, machine safety is no longer a major issue.

The larger value addition in the economy now takes places in services. Service establishments using IT, the Internet and sleeker gadgetry are relatively more comfortable places to work. This has been clearly demonstrated after the pandemic, when such a large amount of work shifted from offices to homes, or for that matter anyplace.

In many cases, the necessity of the workplace has become redundant with the advent of the digital economy. Labour in the gig economy does not provide services to a fixed employer or at a fixed workplace. New studies are indicating that, globally, there will be reduced growth of office space and, soon, no net additions might be needed.

Third, the nature of work itself is changing very fast.

From the physical and manual world of the early days, we have come a long way. While mechanization and robotics reduced the requirement of physical labour, digitalization is changing the very nature of brainy work. Wholesalers and retailers are being replaced by e-commerce companies. Banks and financial services companies are being replaced by fintech and mobile app-based banking and financial services companies.

The changing work and engagement of labour is changing the traditional employer-employee relationship and the need for fixed workplaces.